

Q. The demand for smaller state reflect both democratic aspiration and administrative desperation. "critically examine statement in light of India's federal structure, regional inequalities and cultural diversity?"

→ The demand for smaller state in India is deeply rooted in the quest for identity, representation and empowerment. These aspiration frequently emerge from the historical perception of marginalization on the basis of unique identities, distinct culture etc. The perception that smaller state inherently lead to greater efficiency and improved governance does not always hold true. This poses challenge in administrative governance like strategic vulnerabilities, cost of governance, resource dispute etc.

Key benefit of smaller state:—

1. Decentralized governance → The policy making of the state addresses the specific challenge, preferences and cultural nuances of their population.

ex - Bifurcation of Chhattisgarh from Madhya Pradesh on the basis of distinct culture, economic reasons etc.

2. Economic optimization → To prioritize industries that match their resource, geography or workforce skills.

ex → ~~Ladakh~~ Himachal Pradesh's Baddi for medicine cluster.

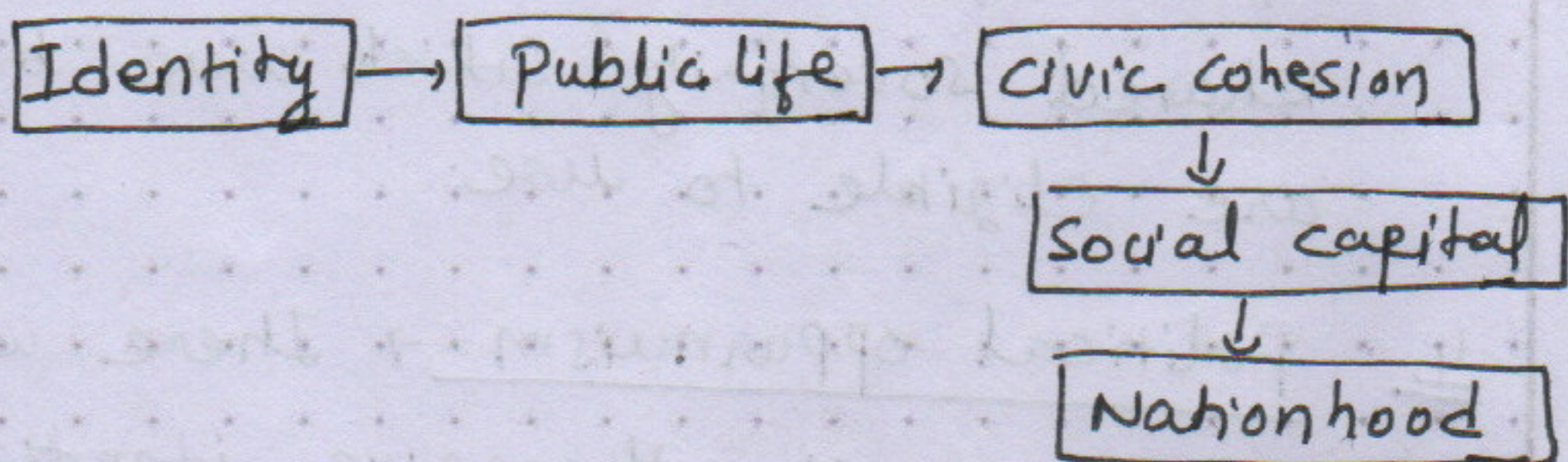
3. Political inclusivity → Unique identity, distinct culture often marginalized in the mainstream political sphere which often lead to discrimination, no representation in administration etc.

ex → Nagaland, Mizoram, etc. often marginalised in mainstream politics.

4 Infrastructure development inequalities → Many a time border of state capital show immense infrastructure development and convenience but other than that infrastructure inequalities is often seen

ex- Coastal ^{area} of Maharashtra is highly developed than Marathwada & Vidharva region.

5. Cultural consolidation → Strong sense of identity and, community, shared culture give confidence to articulate the traditional culture, heritage which lead to tailored policy policies which met their demand.



challenge of smaller states

1. Administrative proliferation → The cost of governance will increase as there will be separate legislature, secretariat, district administration etc.
2. Political Balkanization → This creates domino effect to find a reason for bifurcation which leads to atomic states.
3. Resource dispute → As resource is limited after bifurcation dispute will arise on shared sovereignty which were both states are eligible to use.
4. Political opportunism → There will be increase of obsessive identity politics for their quest of power rather than development.
5. Social isolation → Smaller states may strengthen local identity but they also become disconnected from broader development.

Way forward

1. Rather than demand for small states and strong conflict mechanism resolution ~~to~~ need to be materialize.

ex → ~~zonal~~ Inter-state council

Zonal council

GST council.

2. Fair Intra state resource distribution to be materialize so that other regions don't feel left out in development processes.

HOWEVER, The demand for smaller state in India is ~~justed~~ ~~a~~ ~~an~~ indeed a manifestation of both genuine administrative democratic aspiration and administrative desperation but our response must be focus on governance, equitable development, representation of ~~to~~ ~~max~~ minority section.